

Time Trends Findings

Presentation 5

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Recommendations

1. Optimize staffing schedules to match call volume and duration trends for seniors, improving efficiency and customer experience.
2. Reduce seasonal service decline incidents through better capacity planning and menu redesign.

Recap of Previous Analysis

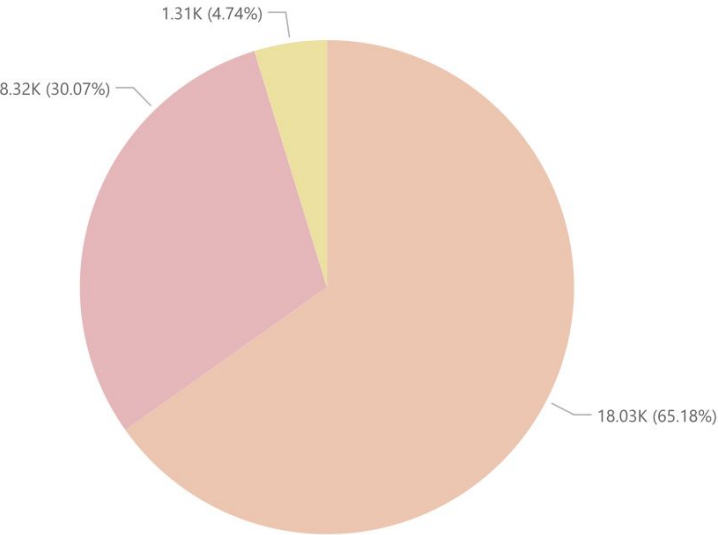
- Most calls do not reach an agent. About a quarter of calls are seniors, and seniors reach an agent even less frequently than non-seniors (~35%).
- Calls to the Seniors menu and its submenus show significantly higher average durations and peak earlier in the day, suggesting these interactions are more complex and time-sensitive than other caller groups.

Dashboard Changes

- **Filled the Blank Radio Buttons** for better user experience
- **Splitting Suburban Seniors** – Split suburban call count breakdown into different senior subgroups, and split call duration breakdown (menu time, agent time, queue time)

While city seniors make up the majority of total calls, suburban seniors have the longest average menu and agent times, suggesting they face a more involved call process.

Call Count by Senior Sub-Group

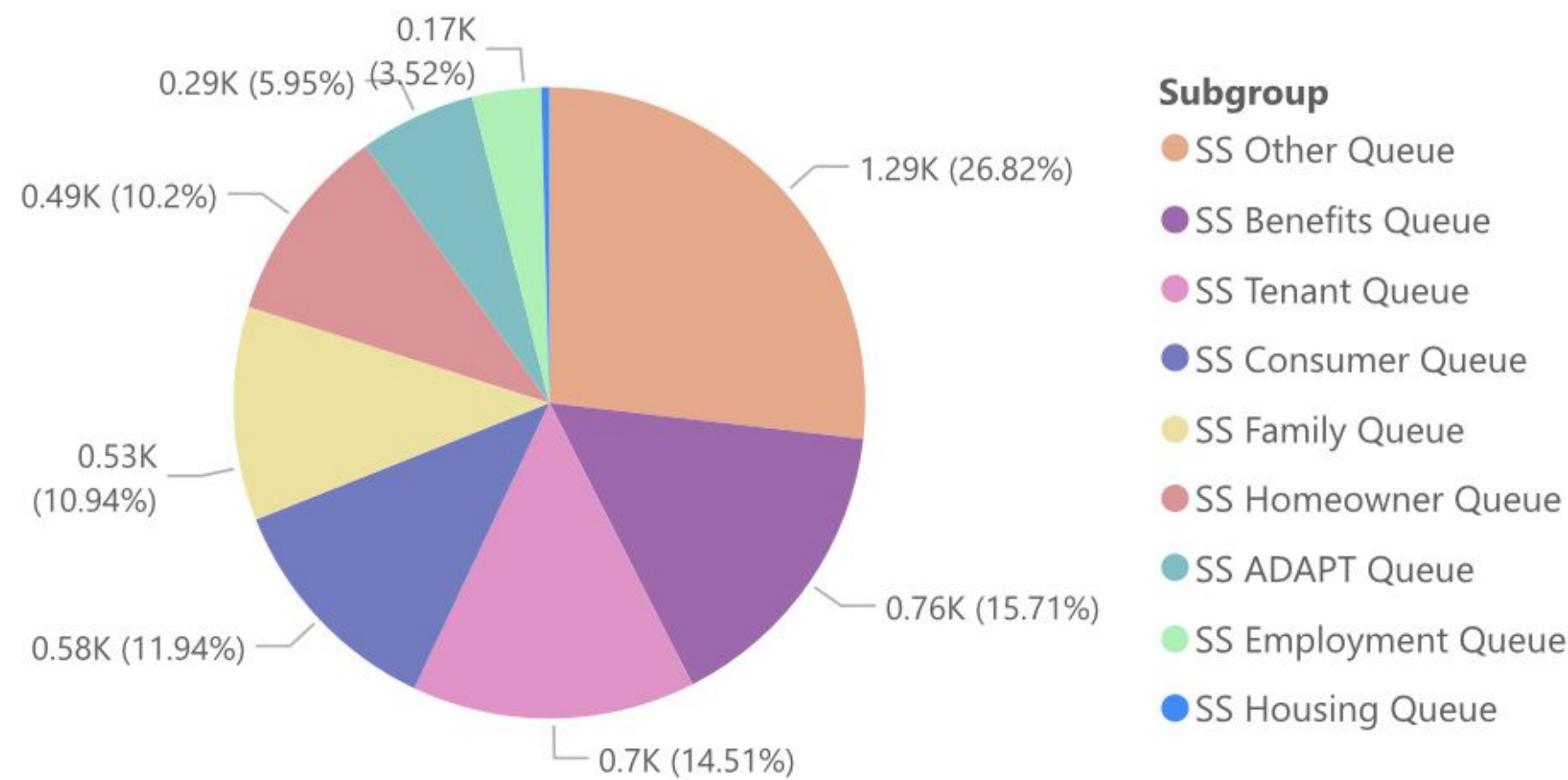


Senior Sub-Group City Seniors (ADAPT Menu) Suburban Seniors ... Seniors: Not Cook ...

City Seniors	Suburban Seniors	Non-Cook County Seniors
7.25	8.42	3.55
Average Menu Time	Average Menu Time	Average Menu Time
1.41	1.25	1.42
Average Queue Time	Average Queue Time	Average Queue Time
3.69	8.15	2.76
Average Agent Time	Average Agent Time	Average Agent Time

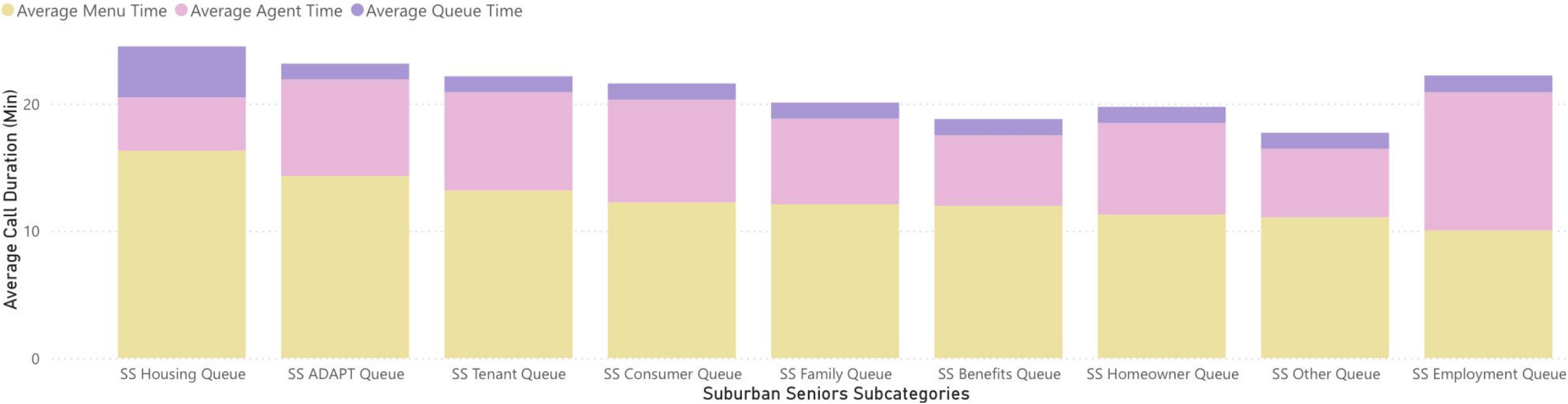
Suburban senior callers most frequently land in the ‘Other’ queue.

Suburban Seniors Call Count Breakdown



Agent time makes up a significant chunk of call durations, especially in SS Employment, while queue delays are highest in SS Housing, suggesting that complexity of issues, not call volume, is what prolongs calls.

Suburban Seniors Average Call Durations Breakdown



Optimize staffing schedules to match call volume and duration trends for seniors, improving efficiency and customer experience.

- Prioritize staffing and training for high-complexity senior subcategories
 - Assign more experienced agents to SS Employment → reduce agent time
 - Rebalance staff so that SS Housing has enough coverage → reduce queue time
- Streamline “Suburban Seniors Other”
 - Suburban Seniors land in the other queue most often → this broad category could be broken down into more specific categories based on call demand

Understanding Call Spikes Is Key to Doing More with Less

- Legal aid already operates on thin budgets, and shifting policies and a volatile economy make grants and donations unpredictable
- Call volumes often exceed capacity—many people seeking help can't get through or face long wait times
- Demand likely does not rise evenly between issues; it some menu options spike at specific times—certain days, weeks, or policy moments see surges while others stay quiet
- By understanding and anticipating these spikes, resources can be allocated when and where they're needed most—helping the organization serve more clients without increasing costs

Service quality varies greatly by season and menu type

[Dashboard Link](#)

Close the gap without adding headcount (I/III)

1. Implement Callback System on MainMenu

The Fix:

- Add "press X to receive a callback" option when wait times exceed 5 minutes
- Caller keeps queue position without staying on hold

Why It Works:

- **32,596 abandoned calls** on MainMenu (31.9% abandonment)
- Problem isn't staffing - MainMenu has 54% agent answer rate (good capacity!)
- People abandon due to long waits, NOT lack of agents
- Reducing abandonment by 25% = **+8,000 calls answered with existing staff**

Close the gap without adding headcount (II/III)

2. Fix November Holiday Staffing

The Fix:

- Require minimum coverage levels during Thanksgiving week or other holidays

Why It Works:

- November volume drops 20% BUT service gets worse (paradox!)
- Family: Closed queue +4.2% despite lower demand
- Employment: Closed queue +5.9% despite lower demand
- Better scheduling = better service with same headcount

Close the gap without adding headcount (III/III)

3. Redistribute Existing Staff During January Peak

The Fix:

- **Temporarily reassign** staff from lower-demand categories to crisis categories
- Move staff FROM: CitySeniors (3.3% agent answer - almost no service happening)
- Move staff TO: Family (66.2% closed in Jan), Employment (70.1% closed), Benefits (65.9% closed)
- Duration: January + February only (8 weeks)

Why It Works:

- CitySeniors only answers 49 of 1,498 calls (essentially abandoned category)
- Those staff hours could answer 300-400 calls in Family/Employment/Benefits
- **Reallocate existing resources to where demand actually is**
- Same total staff cost, much better outcomes

Next Steps

- Validate numbers and fine tune code as needed; in turn, refine recommendations to ensure they are targeted and useful for Cynthia